SLIS 6145: Digital Preservation & Stewardship

27 April 2026

PRESERVING CULTURE, PREVENTING HARM:

ETHICAL RISKS OF SOCIAL MEDIA PRESERVATION FOR IMMIGRANT COMMUNITIES

The University of Iowa

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INTRO:

RETHINKING SOCIAL MEDIA PRESERVATION IN A SURVEILLANCE CONTEXT

Cope, Saira Hussain and Sophia. “EFF to Department of Homeland Security: No Social Media Surveillance of Immigrants.” Electronic Frontier Foundation, 6 June 2025, eff.org/deeplinks/2025/06/eff-department-homeland-security-no-social-media-surveillance-immigrants.

BRENNAN CENTER FOR JUSTICE

- “Social Media Surveillance by Homeland Security Investigations: A Threat to Immigrant Communities and Free Expression.” *Brennan Center for Justice at NYU Law*, Brennan Center for Justice, 15 Nov. 2019, brennancenter.org/our-work/research-reports/social-media-surveillance-homeland-security-investigations-threat.

RESOURCE

Social Media Surveillance by Homeland Security Investigations: A Threat to Immigrant Communities and Free Expression

This resource looks at ICE Homeland Security Investigations, the backbone of the White House's immigration enforcement apparatus, and its dangerous exploitation of social media information.

RESEARCH QUESTIONS

1. How do current digital preservation frameworks consider access and permanence in relation to social media records?

2. In what ways might preserving born-digital social media records expose vulnerable communities to new kinds of surveillance and harm?

3. How can we reinterpret the OAIS concept of Designated Community to better support differentiated access and security for at-risk populations?



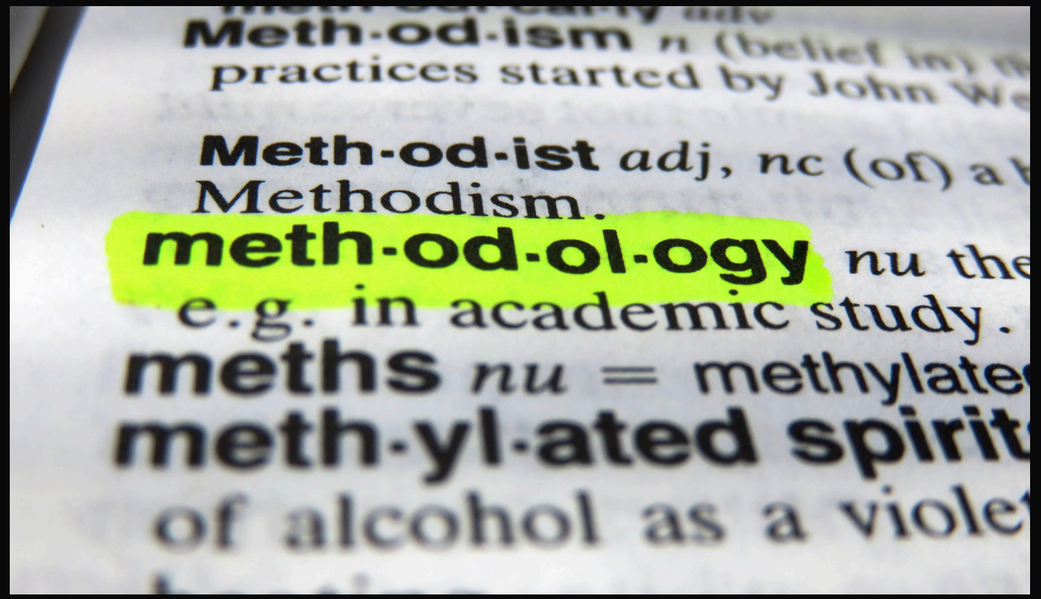
METHODOLOGY

1. LITERATURE REVIEW

- Fondren, Elisabeth, and Meghan Menard McCune. “Archiving and Preserving Social Media at the Library of Congress: Institutional and Cultural Challenges to Build a Twitter Archive.” (2018)
- Guberek, Tamy, et al. “Keeping a Low Profile?: Technology, Risk and Privacy among Undocumented Immigrants.” (2018)
- Sumaita, Inma. “Losing Dignity: Eroding Privacy Rights of Immigrants in Technology-Based Immigration Enforcement.” (2022)
- Tabassum, Sarah, and Cori Faklaris. “Digital Privacy for Migrants: Exploring Current Research Trends and Future Prospects.” (2024)
- Zinaman, Marc. “Social Media Archiving in Practice: A Troubled Landscape in Review.” (2024)

2. CASE STUDIES

- Velte, Ashlyn. “Ethical Challenges and Current Practices in Activist Social Media Archives.” (2018)
  - University-led activist archives
- Lindström, Lisa. *Archiving in the Era of Online Activism (*2019)
  - Swedish activist and trade union archives
- Caswell, Michelle, and Marika Cifor. “Neither a Beginning nor an End.” (2019)
  - South Asian American Digital Archive (SAADA) Islamophobia project



3. CRITICAL ANALYSIS

Reference Model for an Open Archival Information System (OAIS).
CCSDS 650.0-M-2, Magenta Book, Issue 2 (2024)

- Designated Community
- Preservation Watch

KEY TERMS

PRIVACY PARADOX

BOUNDARY TURBULENCE

POST-CUSTODIAL ARCHIVE



ARCHIVAL SURVEILLANCE

GDPR:
GENERAL DATA PROTECTION REGULATION

DESIGNATED COMMUNITY

FEMINIST ETHICS OF CARE



THE ETHICAL MISMATCH

- Fondren, Elisabeth, and Meghan Menard McCune. “Archiving and Preserving Social Media at the Library of Congress: Institutional and Cultural Challenges to Build a Twitter Archive.” *Preservation, Digital Technology & Culture*, vol. 47, no. 2, July 2018, pp. 33–44), doi.org/10.1515/pdtc-2018-0011.
- Zinaman, Marc. “Social Media Archiving in Practice: A Troubled Landscape in Review.” *The Serials Librarian*, vol. 85, nos. 1–4, May 2024, pp. 40–49, doi.org/10.1080/0361526X.2024.2367405.



THE ANALOG/ DIGITAL LEGAL GAP

- Copyright and privacy laws
- Technological innovation
- Digital media proliferation

- Sumaita, Inma. “Losing Dignity: Eroding Privacy Rights of Immigrants in Technology-Based Immigration Enforcement.” *The University of Cincinnati Intellectual Property and Computer Law Journal*, vol. 6, no. 2, Apr. 2022, scholarship.law.uc.edu/ipclj/vol6/iss2/3.
- Zinaman, Marc. “Social Media Archiving in Practice: A Troubled Landscape in Review.” *The Serials Librarian*, vol. 85, nos. 1–4, May 2024, pp. 40–49, doi.org/10.1080/0361526X.2024.2367405.





CONNECTION VS. RISK

- Guberek, Tamy, et al. “Keeping a Low Profile?: Technology, Risk and Privacy among Undocumented Immigrants.” *Proceedings of the 2018 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* [Montreal QC Canada], 2018, pp. 1–15, doi.org/10.1145/3173574.3173688.

I came across your blog site during a web search on Ferguson tweet datasets. We've been doing research on the spread of memes in social media and, like you, thought that the events in Ferguson might make an interesting case study. Unfortunately, during our Twitter data collection (using the Search API) something happened and we missed a few days - from the graph below I'm guessing that we missed tweets on August 15 and 18, and almost all tweets on August 16-17. From your blog post, it looks like you are considering posting the tweet ID dataset that you collected. If so, that would be incredibly useful for our research. Have you posted it somewhere? Would it be possible to get a copy of your dataset?

Thanks for your time,

[11] Email to Ed Summers from social media data mining company representative, dated September 10th, 2014.

ARCHIVAL SURVEILLANCE

IT HAPPENS TO ACTIVISTS.
IS IT HAPPENING TO IMMIGRANTS?

- Jules, Bergis, et al. “Documenting The Now White Paper | Ethical Considerations for Archiving Social Media Content Generated by Contemporary Social Movements: Challenges, Opportunities, and Recommendations.” *Shift Collective*, Apr. 2018, shiftcollective.us/library/p/2018-documenting-the-now-white-paper, p. 5.

UNIVERSITY-LED ACTIVIST ARCHIVES: ETHICAL PRACTICES



- Moderated and controlled access
- The “Hydration” Method for tweet IDs
- Account-based scoping for consent
- Safe ingest locations
- Relationship-building for trust

- Velte, Ashlyn. “Ethical Challenges and Current Practices in Activist Social Media Archives.” *The American Archivist*, vol. 81, no. 1, Mar. 2018, pp. 112–34, doi.org/10.17723/0360-9081-81.1.112.

ONLINE ACTIVIST ARCHIVES

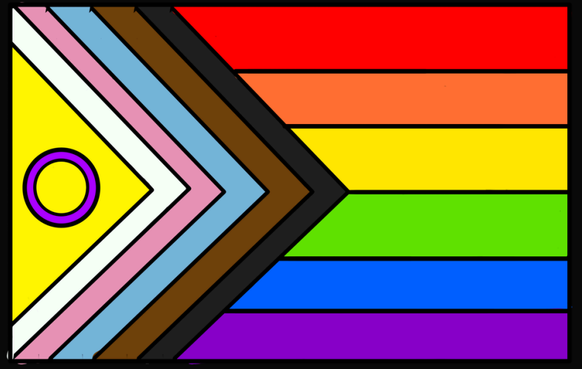
MUSIK VERKET

#MeToo

Pre-ingest anonymization

Voluntary submission

Contact info for others in submitted images

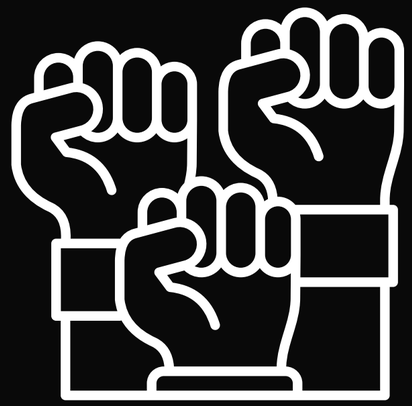


Pride 2018

Security embargoes

Offline preservation

Restricted research access



DigiFacket Trade Unions Archive

- Lindström, Lisa. *Archiving in the Era of Online Activism*. 2019, lup.lub.lu.se/luur/download?func=downloadFile&recordOId=8980793&fileOId=8980795. Lund University.

SAADA

SOUTH ASIAN AMERICAN DIGITAL ARCHIVE

Participatory governance

Contextualizing over collecting

Compensating community labor

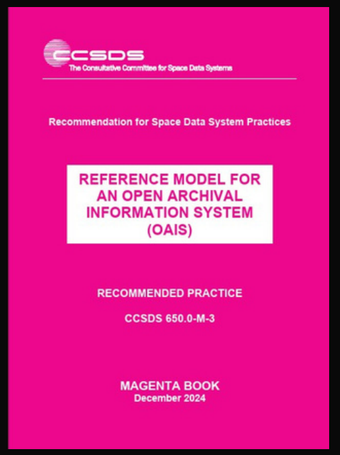
Prioritizing safety over preservation

Post-custodial ownership

IMMIGRANT ARCHIVES: A FEMINIST ETHIC OF CARE

- Caswell, Michelle, and Marika Cifor. “Neither a Beginning nor an End.” *The Routledge International Handbook of New Digital Practices in Galleries, Libraries, Archives, Museums and Heritage Sites*, by Hannah Lewi et al., edited by Hannah Lewi et al., 1st ed., Routledge, 2019, pp. 159–68, doi.org/10.4324/9780429506765-14.

OAIS FRAMEWORK: RESPONSIVENESS AND ADAPTABILITY



- Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems. *Reference Model for an Open Archival Information System (OAIS)*. CCSDS 650.0-M-2, Magenta Book, Issue 2, June 2024. CCSDS, 2024.

2012

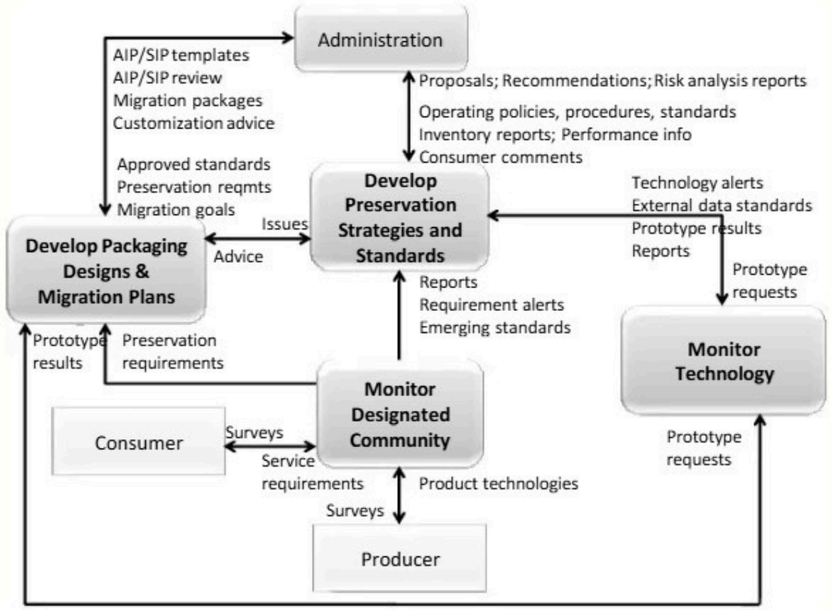


Figure 4-6: Functions of the Preservation Planning Functional Entity

2024

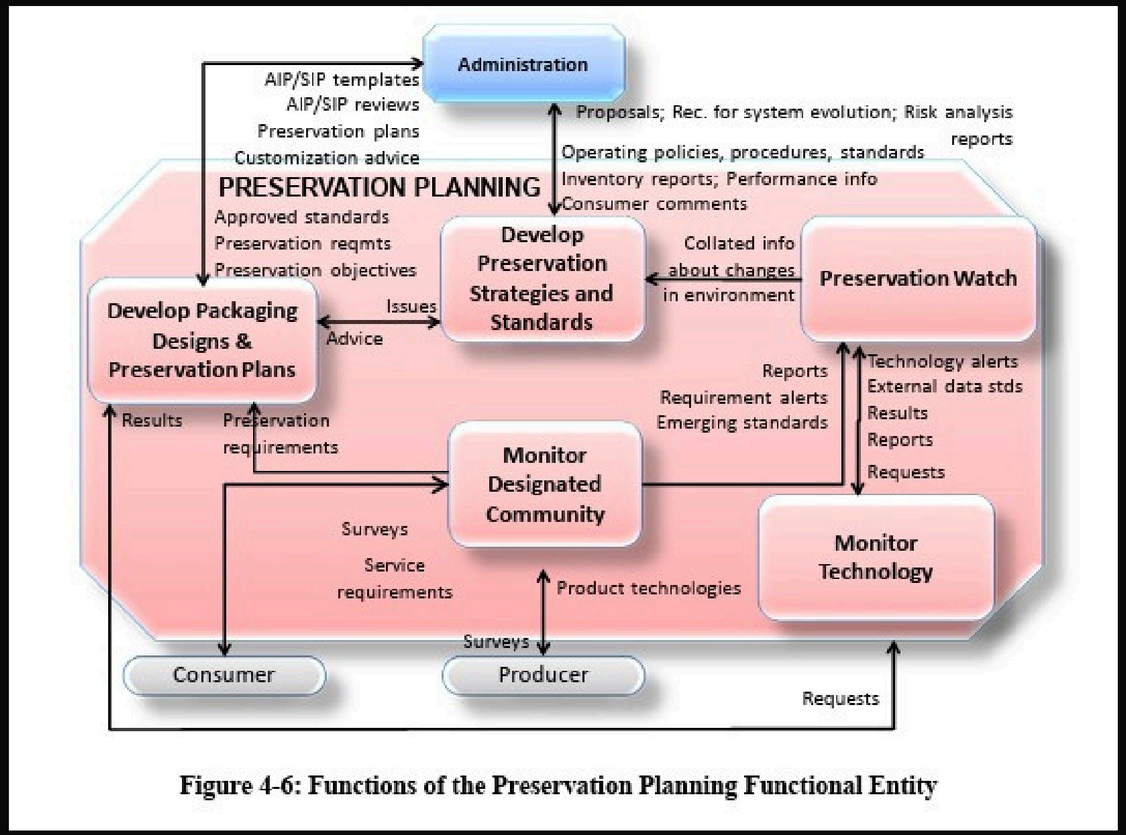


Figure 4-6: Functions of the Preservation Planning Functional Entity

REIMAGINING THE "DESIGNATED COMMUNITY" FOR AT-RISK POPULATIONS



- Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems. *Reference Model for an Open Archival Information System (OAIS)*. CCSDS 650.0-M-2, Magenta Book, Issue 2, June 2024. CCSDS, 2024.
- Steinmeier, Daniel. "Diversity, Inclusion, and Digital Preservation." *Patterns*, vol. 1, no. 9, Nov. 2020, p. 100152. PubMed Central, doi.org/10.1016/j.patter.2020.100152.
- Tabassum, Sarah, and Cori Faklaris. "Digital Privacy for Migrants: Exploring Current Research Trends and Future Prospects." arXiv:2406.02520, arXiv, 4 June 2024. *arXiv.org*, doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2406.02520.
- Yakel, Elizabeth, et al. "An Empirical Examination of Data Reuser Trust in a Digital Repository." *Journal of the Association for Information Science and Technology*, vol. 75, no. 8, Aug. 2024, pp. 898–915, doi.org/10.1002/asi.24933.

FINDINGS

TAKE-AWAYS

- Awareness of ethical and legal concerns around social media collecting
- Possible archival silences/symbolic annihilation
  - Current research focuses on:
    - Activist social media archives
    - Privacy and risk with immigrant technology use
- OAIS Framework update includes promising changes
  - Archivists and digital preservationists must be willing to do the work



TOOLS

- *Documenting the Now*
  - docnow.io/
- *Documenting in Times of Crisis: A Resource Kit* from the Society of American Archivists
  - archivists.org/advocacy/documenting-in-times-of-crisis-a-resource-kit.

FUTURE RESEARCH

- Archival surveillance of vulnerable populations
  - especially immigrants, refugees, asylum seekers, and migrants
- Social media archives focused on immigrant cultural heritage
- Immigrant-centered archives that include social media collections



CONCLUSION

- Key Learnings:
  - Social media archiving in practice (ethics, consent, privacy)
  - OAIS + Designated Community (trust, inclusion)
- Challenges:
  - Limited directly aligned research
  - Research gap?
- In Progress:
  - Outreach to SAADA & Queens Memory Project
- Rewards:
  - Deep learning & meaningful conversations

QUESTIONS?



BIBLIOGRAPHY

- Caswell, Michelle, and Marika Cifor. “Neither a Beginning nor an End.” *The Routledge International Handbook of New Digital Practices in Galleries, Libraries, Archives, Museums and Heritage Sites*, by Hannah Lewi et al., edited by Hannah Lewi et al., 1st ed., Routledge, 2019, pp. 159–68, doi.org/10.4324/9780429506765-14.
- Caswell, Michelle, et al. “‘To Suddenly Discover Yourself Existing’: Uncovering the Impact of Community Archives.” *American Archivist*, vol. 79, no. 1, July 2016. escholarship.org, escholarship.org/uc/item/0nd5g0p7.
- Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems. *Reference Model for an Open Archival Information System (OAIS)*. CCSDS 650.0-M-2, Magenta Book, Issue 2, June 2024. CCSDS, 2024.
- Cope, Saira Hussain and Sophia. “EFF to Department of Homeland Security: No Social Media Surveillance of Immigrants.” *Electronic Frontier Foundation*, 6 June 2025, eff.org/deeplinks/2025/06/eff-department-homeland-security-no-social-media-surveillance-immigrants.
- Fondren, Elisabeth, and Meghan Menard McCune. “Archiving and Preserving Social Media at the Library of Congress: Institutional and Cultural Challenges to Build a Twitter Archive.” *Preservation, Digital Technology & Culture*, vol. 47, no. 2, July 2018, pp. 33–44), doi.org/10.1515/pdtc-2018-0011.
- Jules, Bergis, et al. “Documenting The Now White Paper | Ethical Considerations for Archiving Social Media Content Generated by Contemporary Social Movements: Challenges, Opportunities, and Recommendations.” *Shift Collective*, Apr. 2018, shiftcollective.us/library/p/2018-documenting-the-now-white-paper.
- Lindström, Lisa. *Archiving in the Era of Online Activism*. 2019, lup.lub.lu.se/luur/download?func=downloadFile&recordOId=8980793&fileOId=8980795. Lund University.
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PHOTO CREDITS

IN ORDER OF APPEARANCE

- Slide 2: Screenshot from eff.org/deeplinks/2025/06/eff-department-homeland-security-no-social-media-surveillance-immigrants
- Slide 3: Screenshots from brennancenter.org/our-work/research-reports/social-media-surveillance-homeland-security-investigations-threat
- Slide 4: “A question mark on a notebook” by Lina Darjan's Images via Canva Pro
- Slide 5: “Methodology - dictionary definition” by tzahiV from Getty Images Signature via Canva Pro
- Slide 6: “Light Bulb Made of Crumpled Yellow Paper” by christianhorz via Canva Pro
- Slide 7: “Interior View of Library of Congress in Washington D.C.” by Brett Aukburg from Pexels via Canva Pro
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  - “Person using smartphone with social media icons” by Codrut Tomescu's Images via Canva Pro
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  - “WhatsApp_Logo_2.png” by WhatsApp Logo from logosandbrands via Canva
- Slide 10: Screenshot from shiftcollective.us/library/p/2018-documenting-the-now-white-paper, p. 5
- Slide 11: “University sign” by sshepard from Getty Images Signature via Canva Pro
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  - “9976991.png” (Pride Flag) by Flight_of_fantasy from pixabay via Canva Pro
  - “Workers Union line icon” by santerabos from santerabos via Canva Pro
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- Slide 14: Screenshots from The Magenta Book PDF: Consultative Committee for Space Data Systems. *Reference Model for an Open Archival Information System (OAIS)*. CCSDS 650.0-M-2, Magenta Book, Issue 2, June 2024. CCSDS, 2024
- Slide 15: “Reimagining Designated Communities Word Cloud” by Jessica Mendes Ford
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THANK YOU SO MUCH!